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1931, ‘Mahatma Ji Is Great’

Bhagat Singh was a contender for power with Gandhi. Had he lived, Gandhi would have been forced to share power with him. When Bhagat Singh wrote to young political workers on 2 February 1931 (just over a month before he was to be executed), he urged that ‘for any revolutionary party a definite programme is very essential’ because ‘you must know that revolution means action’ and that ‘[i]t means a change brought about deliberately by an organised and systematic work’. He further wrote,

> We want a socialist revolution, the indispensable preliminary to which is the political revolution. That is what we want. The political revolution does not mean the transfer of state (or more crudely, the power) from the hands of the British to the Indians, but to Indians who are at one with us as to the final goal, or to be more precise, the power to be transferred to the revolutionary part through popular support. After that, to proceed in right earnest is to organise the reconstruction of the whole society on the socialist basis.[1]

Since he distrusted the middle classes, he proclaimed, ‘The only forces on which you can rely to bring about any revolution, whether national or the socialist, are the peasantry and the labour. Congress leaders do not dare organise those forces,’ because to ‘their hearts’ desire – Dominion Status’, which he was against, was what they were after. He drew upon the evidence and asserted that ‘[y]ou can easily judge it by studying the resolutions of the last three sessions of the Congress’ which were at ‘Madras, Calcutta and Lahore’, one can see how ‘[a]t Calcutta, they passed a resolution asking for Dominion Status within twelve months, otherwise they would be forced to adopt complete independence as their object . . .’.

He continued, ‘It is this half-heartedness that we hate, not the compromise at a particular stage in the struggle.’ He wished to protect the